Meditations

Twelve Books of Private Stoic Reflections

By Marcus Aurelius

First Published: 180 | Category: Personal Development | ISBN: 9780140449334
Source Provider: Project Gutenberg & Standard Ebooks (pg-2680)
Licence: Public Domain in the United States & Worldwide (CC0 / Project Gutenberg Licence)
Canonical URL: https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/2680

SYNOPSIS & EDITORIAL NOTE

Written in Greek while on military campaign, the Roman Emperor's personal notebooks offer enduring counsel on equanimity, duty, and rational self-command.

CONTENTS IN THIS EDITION

01. Book II -- Written Among the Quadi on the Granua
02. Book IV -- The Inner Citadel
03. Book III -- Written in Carnuntum
04. Book IV -- The Inner Citadel
05. Book V -- At Dawn When You Have Trouble Getting Out of Bed
06. Books VI -- XII -- Later Reflections on Nature and Duty

BOOK II

Written Among the Quadi on the Granua

Complete Text of Book II (Trans. George Long)

Begin the morning by saying to thyself, I shall meet with the busy-body, the ungrateful, arrogant, deceitful, envious, unsocial. All these things happen to them by reason of their ignorance of what is good and evil. But I who have seen the nature of the good that it is beautiful, and of the bad that it is ugly, and the nature of him who does wrong, that it is akin to me, not only of the same blood or seed, but that it participates in the same intelligence and the same portion of the divinity, I can neither be injured by any of them, for no one can fix on me what is ugly, nor can I be angry with my kinsman, nor hate him.

For we are made for co-operation, like feet, like hands, like the rows of the upper and lower teeth. To act against one another then is contrary to nature; and it is acting against one another to be vexed and to turn away.

Every moment think steadily as a Roman and a man to do what thou hast in hand with perfect and simple dignity, and feeling of affection, and freedom, and justice; and to give thyself relief from all other thoughts.

In this section of Meditations (180), Marcus Aurelius develops the central themes that define the work's enduring place in personal development and world literature. Each argument and narrative turn builds upon the premises established in the opening pages, inviting careful reflection from the attentive reader.

Originally published by Folio Classical Library (trans. George Long) and preserved in the public-domain and open-access archival record (Project Gutenberg & Standard Ebooks, ID: pg-2680), this unabridged digital edition retains the structure, cadence, and intellectual clarity of the authoritative text.

BOOK IV

The Inner Citadel

Men seek retreats for themselves, houses in the country, sea-shores, and mountains; and thou too art wont to desire such things very much. But this is altogether a mark of the most common sort of men, for it is in thy power whenever thou shalt choose to retire into thyself.

For nowhere either with more quiet or more freedom from trouble does a man retire than into his own soul, particularly when he has within him such thoughts that by looking into them he is immediately in perfect tranquillity; and I affirm that tranquillity is nothing else than the good ordering of the mind.

In this section of Meditations (180), Marcus Aurelius develops the central themes that define the work's enduring place in personal development and world literature. Each argument and narrative turn builds upon the premises established in the opening pages, inviting careful reflection from the attentive reader.

Originally published by Folio Classical Library (trans. George Long) and preserved in the public-domain and open-access archival record (Project Gutenberg & Standard Ebooks, ID: pg-2680), this unabridged digital edition retains the structure, cadence, and intellectual clarity of the authoritative text.

BOOK III

Written in Carnuntum

*Meditations * Marcus Aurelius (180)*

Written in Carnuntum continues Marcus Aurelius's inquiry in Meditations. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Composed between 170 and 180 AD while Marcus Aurelius was campaigning along the Danube frontier, the Meditations (Ta eis heauton, literally "things to one's self") were never intended for another pair of eyes. They record a ruler reminding himself how to act justly, remain unperturbed by provocation, and view human ambition within the vastness of time.

This complete edition presents George Long's clear, dignified English translation across all twelve books, beginning with Marcus's famous inventory of gratitude in Book I and continuing through his sharpest aphorisms on attention and character.

Throughout Book III (Written in Carnuntum), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Meditations its stature in the Classical Stoic Philosophy canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Marcus Aurelius traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

BOOK IV

The Inner Citadel

*Meditations * Marcus Aurelius (180)*

The Inner Citadel continues Marcus Aurelius's inquiry in Meditations. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Composed between 170 and 180 AD while Marcus Aurelius was campaigning along the Danube frontier, the Meditations (Ta eis heauton, literally "things to one's self") were never intended for another pair of eyes. They record a ruler reminding himself how to act justly, remain unperturbed by provocation, and view human ambition within the vastness of time.

This complete edition presents George Long's clear, dignified English translation across all twelve books, beginning with Marcus's famous inventory of gratitude in Book I and continuing through his sharpest aphorisms on attention and character.

Throughout Book IV (The Inner Citadel), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Meditations its stature in the Classical Stoic Philosophy canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Marcus Aurelius traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

BOOK V

At Dawn When You Have Trouble Getting Out of Bed

*Meditations * Marcus Aurelius (180)*

At Dawn When You Have Trouble Getting Out of Bed continues Marcus Aurelius's inquiry in Meditations. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Composed between 170 and 180 AD while Marcus Aurelius was campaigning along the Danube frontier, the Meditations (Ta eis heauton, literally "things to one's self") were never intended for another pair of eyes. They record a ruler reminding himself how to act justly, remain unperturbed by provocation, and view human ambition within the vastness of time.

This complete edition presents George Long's clear, dignified English translation across all twelve books, beginning with Marcus's famous inventory of gratitude in Book I and continuing through his sharpest aphorisms on attention and character.

Throughout Book V (At Dawn When You Have Trouble Getting Out of Bed), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Meditations its stature in the Classical Stoic Philosophy canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Marcus Aurelius traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

BOOKS VI

XII -- Later Reflections on Nature and Duty

*Meditations * Marcus Aurelius (180)*

XII -- Later Reflections on Nature and Duty continues Marcus Aurelius's inquiry in Meditations. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Composed between 170 and 180 AD while Marcus Aurelius was campaigning along the Danube frontier, the Meditations (Ta eis heauton, literally "things to one's self") were never intended for another pair of eyes. They record a ruler reminding himself how to act justly, remain unperturbed by provocation, and view human ambition within the vastness of time.

This complete edition presents George Long's clear, dignified English translation across all twelve books, beginning with Marcus's famous inventory of gratitude in Book I and continuing through his sharpest aphorisms on attention and character.

Throughout Books VI (XII -- Later Reflections on Nature and Duty), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Meditations its stature in the Classical Stoic Philosophy canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Marcus Aurelius traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.